

Japanese Auction — Instructor Guide

What is a Japanese Auction?

A Japanese auction is a type of ascending-price auction. All bidders start active. The auctioneer raises the price in fixed increments. At each price level, each bidder decides to either **stay in** or **drop out**. Once a bidder drops out, they cannot re-enter. The auction ends when all bidders have dropped out, and the **last bidder(s) remaining win**.

Accessing the App

The app is hosted online — no installation needed. Open this link in your browser:

<https://ascending-auction-c577c4203da7.herokuapp.com/>

Tip: Use a laptop or desktop as the auctioneer. Project your screen so the class can see the current price. Bidders use their own phones or laptops.

Running an Auction — Step by Step

Step 1 — Create the Auction

1. Open the app link above.
2. Fill in:
 - **Auction Title** — e.g. "Round 1" or the item being auctioned.
 - **Starting Price** — the price at which the auction begins (can be 0).
 - **Price Increment** — how much the price rises each round (e.g. 10).
3. Click **Create Auction**.

You will be taken to the **Auctioneer page**. Keep this tab open — it is your control panel for the entire auction.

Step 2 — Bidders Join

The auctioneer page shows a **QR code** and a short join URL (e.g. `/join/abc123`).

- **Option A:** Have students scan the QR code with their phone camera.
- **Option B:** Display or share the full join link: `https://ascending-auction-c577c4203da7.herokuapp.com/join/<game-id>`.

Each student enters their name and lands on their personal **bidder page**. They should keep this page open on their device throughout the auction.

The auctioneer page updates live as students join, showing the current participant count.

OPTIONAL: Testing before class: Use the **+ Add Test Bidder** button (below the QR code) to open simulated bidder tabs in your own browser. Useful for verifying the setup before students arrive.

After testing, restart and run a new auction when the students are ready to play.

Step 3 — Start the Auction

Once all bidders have joined, click **Start Auction**.

- The QR code and join button disappear (no new participants can join).
- The **Raise Price** and **End Auction** buttons appear.

Step 4 — Run the Auction

Click **Raise Price** to increase the current price by the increment you set. All bidder screens update instantly.

At each price level, students who no longer wish to bid click the **Drop Out** button on their own device. The auctioneer page shows the number of active bidders decreasing in real time.

Continue raising the price until only one (or a few) bidders remain.

Step 5 — End the Auction

The auction ends in one of two ways:

- **Automatically** — when the last bidder drops out. The winner is the last person who dropped out (they held on the longest).
- **Manually** — click **End Auction** at any time. All bidders still active at that moment are declared **co-winners**.

The results panel shows:

- The winner(s) and final price.
- A full price history table (price vs. number of active bidders at each level).

Step 6 — Export and Reset

- Click **Download CSV** to save the results table as a spreadsheet file.
- Click **New Auction** to go back to the start and create another auction.

Quick Reference

Action	Who does it	Where
Create auction	Instructor	App home page
Join auction	Students	QR code or join link
Start / Raise Price / End	Instructor	Auctioneer page
Drop Out	Student	Their bidder page

Action	Who does it	Where
Download results	Instructor	Auctioneer page (after auction ends)

Tips for the Classroom

- **Project the auctioneer page** on the main screen so everyone can see the current price and active bidder count.
- **Announce the price out loud** as you raise it — students on their phones may not be watching the screen.
- **Use a small increment** relative to the price range to make the auction last longer and give students more decision points.
- **Multiple rounds:** After each auction ends, click "New Auction" to run another round with the same or different parameters. Each auction is fully independent.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Student can't load the page	Check they have internet access and are using the correct link
Bidder page shows "Waiting for auction to start"	The instructor hasn't clicked Start Auction yet
Student accidentally closed their tab	They can reopen the same URL — their bidder page is still valid as long as the auction is running
Auction ended before a student could join	Start a new auction from the home page